

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Languages, Scripts, Literature and Manuscripts - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

| Languages, Scripts, Literature and Manuscripts                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                         |
| 01 FOUNDATION — THE CLASSIFICATION FIREWALL<br>Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and                                | 02 FOUNDATION — SANSKRIT AND PRAKRIT AS COEXISTING REGISTERS<br>Evidence chain: Sanskrit and Prakrit coexistence Qualified use: Explain |
| 03 FOUNDATION — PALI AND THE LITERARY PRAKRITS<br>Evidence chain: Middle Indo-Aryan registers Qualified use: Prepare                        | 04 CORE — PANINI AND THE SANSKRIT EPIGRAPHIC RECORD<br>Evidence chain: Grammar and Sanskrit epigraphy Qualified use: Build              |
| 05 CORE — ASHOKAN SCRIPTS AND LANGUAGES<br>Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the                               | 06 CORE — KUSHANA MULTILINGUAL COEXISTENCE<br>Several scripts and registers can operate under one polity.                               |
| 07 CORE — LAYERED VEDIC, EPIC AND PURANIC CORPORA<br>Evidence chain: Layered early corpora Qualified use: Use text-layer                    | 08 CORE — BUDDHIST AND JAIN TEXTUAL WORLDS<br>Religious corpus does not imply one language or one period.                               |
| 09 CORE — SANGAM LITERATURE AS BOUNDED EVIDENCE<br>Evidence chain: Sangam evidence boundary Qualified use: Write                            | 10 CORE — CLASSICAL SANSKRIT ATTRIBUTION<br>Evidence chain: Classical attribution discipline Qualified use: Prepare                     |
| 11 CORE — PALLAVA LITERATURE AND SCRIPT CULTURE<br>Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions                      | 12 CORE — VERNACULAR AND URDU LITERARY PUBLICS<br>The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and                    |
| 13 CORE SYNTHESIS — LANGUAGE AS STAGED HIERARCHY<br>Evidence chain: Language as staged social marker Qualified use: Use                     | 14 CORE SYNTHESIS — MANUSCRIPTS AND RECOGNITION DATES<br>Evidence chain: Text date versus recognition date -                            |
| 15 CORE SYNTHESIS — VERIFIED PYQS AND FINAL LANGUAGE ANSWER SPINE<br>□ India has a constitutionally declared "national language." - No such |                                                                                                                                         |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Classification firewall?

A. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Classification firewall?

A. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. B. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. C. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Classification firewall?

A. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Classification firewall?

A. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Four major language families?

A. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. B. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Four major language families?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

#### Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four major language families?

A. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four major language families?

A. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. B. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. D. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Sanskrit and Prakrit coexistence?

A. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. B. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. C. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. D. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Sanskrit and Prakrit coexistence?

A. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. B. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sanskrit and Prakrit coexistence?

A. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



### Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sanskrit and Prakrit coexistence?

A. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Middle Indo-Aryan registers?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Middle Indo-Aryan registers?

A. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. B. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. D. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Middle Indo-Aryan registers?

A. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. B. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. C. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. D. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



### Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Middle Indo-Aryan registers?

A. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Grammar and Sanskrit epigraphy?

A. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. B. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Grammar and Sanskrit epigraphy?

A. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. B. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. C. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. D. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Grammar and Sanskrit epigraphy?

A. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. D. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Grammar and Sanskrit epigraphy?**

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Ashokan multilingual record?**

A. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. D. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Ashokan multilingual record?**

A. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. B. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. C. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. D. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ashokan multilingual record?**

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. D. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ashokan multilingual record?**

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Brahmi and Kharoshthi?**

A. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. D. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Brahmi and Kharoshthi?**

A. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. B. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. C. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. D. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Brahmi and Kharoshthi?**

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. C. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Brahmi and Kharoshthi?

A. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. B. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. C. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. D. Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Kushana coexistence?

A. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Kushana coexistence?

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kushana coexistence?

A. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. B. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. C. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kushana coexistence?

A. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. B. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. C. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. D. Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Layered early corpora?

A. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. B. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. C. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. D. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Layered early corpora?

A. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. B. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. C. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. D. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Layered early corpora?

A. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. B. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. C. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



### Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Layered early corpora?

A. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. B. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Buddhist and Jain textual worlds?

A. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. B. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. C. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. D. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Buddhist and Jain textual worlds?

A. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. B. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. C. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. D. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Buddhist and Jain textual worlds?

A. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. B. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. C. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. D. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Buddhist and Jain textual worlds?**

A. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. B. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Sangam evidence boundary?**

A. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. B. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. C. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Sangam evidence boundary?**

A. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. B. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sangam evidence boundary?**

A. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. D. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian.



**Answer: C. Explanation: The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sangam evidence boundary?**

A. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Classical attribution discipline?**

A. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. B. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. C. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. D. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Classical attribution discipline?**

A. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. B. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. C. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. D. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Classical attribution discipline?**

A. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkanī, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gīnan must be used as distinct historical labels. B. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. C. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. D. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Classical attribution discipline?**

A. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. D. Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Pallava literary route?**

A. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. B. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. C. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. D. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Pallava literary route?**

A. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. B. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. C. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. D. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Pallava literary route?

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. D. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Pallava literary route?

A. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. B. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. C. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. D. Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Vernacular expansion?

A. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkhani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and gitan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Vernacular expansion?

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. C. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. D. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Vernacular expansion?

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. C. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. D. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Vernacular expansion?

A. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. D. The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Urdu as Indian literary formation?

A. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. B. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. C. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. D. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Urdu as Indian literary formation?

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. C. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. D. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Urdu as Indian literary formation?

A. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. D. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Urdu as Indian literary formation?

A. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. D. The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Language as staged social marker?

A. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. B. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. C. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. D. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Language as staged social marker?

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. C. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. D. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



**Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Language as staged social marker?**

A. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. B. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. C. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. D. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Language as staged social marker?**

A. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Text date versus recognition date?**

A. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. D. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Text date versus recognition date?**

A. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. B. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. C. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. D. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**



**Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Text date versus recognition date?**

A. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. D. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Text date versus recognition date?**

A. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Documentary-heritage diversity?**

A. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians.

**Answer: A. Explanation: India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Documentary-heritage diversity?**

A. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. B. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. C. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. D. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another.

**Answer: B. Explanation: India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Documentary-heritage diversity?**

A. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. B. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. C. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: C. Explanation: India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Documentary-heritage diversity?**

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture.

**Answer: D. Explanation: India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Manuscript survey and custody?**

A. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Manuscript survey and custody?**

A. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. B. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Manuscript survey and custody?

A. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. B. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. C. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. D. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Manuscript survey and custody?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

### Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?

A. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?".

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?

**Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified language PYQ routes?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtra with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. D. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another.

**Answer: B. Explanation:** The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?  
**Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** B. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to

this topic. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified language PYQ routes?”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

### Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. C. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

**Demand decoding:** Treat “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.



3. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified language PYQ routes?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

### Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes?

A. Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. B. Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the owner; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. D. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.**

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

**Demand decoding:** Treat “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes?” as a form, chronology, region, patron, medium and status problem. Verify every pairing independently without inventing an official key.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes? **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** D. The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the cultural demand in “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes?”.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the category and period; pair form with region, material, patron or institution; separate historical fact from later label or current recognition; eliminate the closest distractor.

**Why this earns marks:** It preserves answer-text integrity and exact category mapping while keeping reasoned elimination separate from an official key.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified language PYQ routes?”, state why the nearest distractor fails on medium, region, chronology, patronage, terminology or recognition status.

## TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

No direct GS-I Mains PYQ is routed solely to Topic 11. The audited objective routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa, and provisional 2026 place-value notation; the 2024 Pallava Mains demand is cross-owned through Topic 03, so no objective answer letter or fabricated direct Mains ownership is supplied.

## OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

### 7. Exact PYQ application

**FACT: 2024 Q2, verbatim:** "Estimate the contribution of Pallavas of Kanchi for the development of art and literature of South India. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2024 GS Paper I.txt:15-20). **ANALYSIS:** The literature component of this answer should cite Kanchipuram as a centre of Sanskrit scholarship under Pallava patronage, referencing Dandin's *Avantisundari Katha* (7th-8th century Sanskrit scholar associated with the Pallava court, praising Mahabalipuram's artisans - cross-referenced from topic

03. as direct textual evidence of Pallava-era literary activity alongside architectural patronage.

### 2026 PYQ Integration

**Status:** 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper        | Q | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)                                             | Directive / format                                                                  | Source status                                                                                                                               | Owner requirement                                                         |
|------|--------------|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | Prelims GS-I | 7 | Place-value notation in Indian epigraphic and Southeast Asian inscriptions | Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred | Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026-■GS1-■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Place-value notation in Indian epigraphic and Southeast Asian inscriptions

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

### Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

**Status:** 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper        | Q  | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)          | Directive / format                                                            | Source status                                                                       | Owner requirement                                                         |
|------|--------------|----|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Prelims GS-I | 63 | Work attributed to the playwright Bhasa | Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred | Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Work attributed to the playwright Bhasa

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

### Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

**Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper        | Q  | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)                        | Directive / format                                   | Source status                   | Owner requirement                                                         |
|------|--------------|----|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2021 | Prelims GS-I | 41 | Bhavabhuti Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara identification | Objective question; official key unavailable locally | Routed; key unavailable locally | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Bhavabhuti Hastimalla and Kshemeshvara identification

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

### 8. Exact PYQ application

**FACT: 2024 Q2 (Pallava art and literature), advanced support:** an advanced answer should name Dandin's *Avantisundari Katha* specifically (topic 03 cross-reference) as direct textual evidence of Pallava-era Sanskrit literary activity, and may use the composition-vs-recognition distinction (Section 2) to note that Pallava-era texts and inscriptions require separate literary-historical dating from any later manuscript "discovery" or documentation event, avoiding the common error of treating a text's rediscovery date as its composition date.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Distinguish language family, script, literary register and constitutional or heritage status. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** India's linguistic diversity becomes intelligible only when genealogical, graphic, social-literary and legal classifications are kept separate.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another.
- Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another.
- Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family.

**Qualified conclusion:** India's linguistic diversity becomes intelligible only when genealogical, graphic, social-literary and legal classifications are kept separate.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish language family, script, literary register and constitutional or heritage status...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** India's linguistic diversity becomes intelligible only when genealogical, graphic, social-literary and legal classifications are kept separate.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Language family, script, literary register, constitutional status, classical-language recognition and documentary-heritage recognition are separate classifications; none may be inferred from another. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Indo-Aryan within Indo-European, Dravidian, Austroasiatic and Tibeto-Burman are the four major family groupings used by the owner; no family is culturally more Indian than another. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Brahmi is an ancestral script with many regional descendants, while Kharoshthi ran right-to-left and was used especially in the northwest; neither name denotes a language family. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** India's linguistic diversity becomes intelligible only when genealogical, graphic, social-literary and legal classifications are kept separate.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Distinguish language family, script, literary register and constitutional or heritage status...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Explain why Sangam literature is powerful but bounded historical evidence. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** The corpus illuminates social and material worlds through layered poems, but compilation history prevents its use as a continuous dynastic chronicle.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date.
- The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle.

**Qualified conclusion:** The corpus illuminates social and material worlds through layered poems, but compilation history prevents its use as a continuous dynastic chronicle.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain why Sangam literature is powerful but bounded historical evidence. Answer in about...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The corpus illuminates social and material worlds through layered poems, but compilation history prevents its use as a continuous dynastic chronicle.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, early Upanishads, epics and Puranas have layered oral, compositional, redactional and manuscript histories and should not be assigned one publication date. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Sangam corpus, compiled around CE 300-600 with older layers, illuminates towns, trade, crafts, war, ranking and hero-stone culture but is not a connected dynastic chronicle. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** The corpus illuminates social and material worlds through layered poems, but compilation history prevents its use as a continuous dynastic chronicle.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Explain why Sangam literature is powerful but bounded historical evidence. Answer in about...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Examine the coexistence of Sanskrit, Prakrit and regional literary languages. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** Indian literary history is a division of labour among overlapping registers and publics rather than a succession in which one language eliminates another.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit.



- Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart.
- Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.
- The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian.
- The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels.

**Qualified conclusion:** Indian literary history is a division of labour among overlapping registers and publics rather than a succession in which one language eliminates another.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **examine** requires a direct position on “Examine the coexistence of Sanskrit, Prakrit and regional literary languages. Answer in about...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Indian literary history is a division of labour among overlapping registers and publics rather than a succession in which one language eliminates another.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Sanskrit and the Prakrit registers performed different literary and social functions and coexisted; Prakrit is not merely a later or corrupted Sanskrit. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Pali is associated with the Theravada canon, Ardhamagadhi especially with the Svetambara Jain canon, and Shauraseni and Maharashtri with major dramatic or literary uses; historical speech cannot be reduced to one neat branch chart. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The rise of Hindi and other regional literatures expanded literary publics through Bhakti, court and translation networks without causing the disappearance of Sanskrit or Persian. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner classes Urdu as Indo-Aryan, structured on Khari Boli and shaped through Persian-Hindi interaction in India; Dakkani, qaseeda, shahr ashob and ginan must be used as distinct historical labels. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** Indian literary history is a division of labour among overlapping registers and publics rather than a succession in which one language eliminates another.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Examine the coexistence of Sanskrit, Prakrit and regional literary languages. Answer in about...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Assess Pallava contributions to literature and script culture within the wider art-and-literature demand. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** Named textual, bilingual epigraphic and court-script evidence makes Pallava literary patronage demonstrable, while the court-use limit prevents overgeneralisation.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the region; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions.
- Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region.

**Qualified conclusion:** Named textual, bilingual epigraphic and court-script evidence makes Pallava literary patronage demonstrable, while the court-use limit prevents overgeneralisation.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess Pallava contributions to literature and script culture within the wider art-and-...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Named textual, bilingual epigraphic and court-script evidence makes Pallava literary patronage demonstrable, while the court-use limit prevents overgeneralisation.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Panini's Ashtadhyayi systematised Sanskrit grammar, while Rudradaman I's Junagarh inscription around 150 CE is the earliest extensive datable Sanskrit inscriptional evidence in the region; literary antiquity and epigraphic chronology are different questions. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Dandin's Avantisundari Katha, bilingual Tamil-Sanskrit inscriptions and Pallava-Grantha court use supply the literature-and-script side of the 2024 Pallava demand; court usage must not be generalised to all writing in the region. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** Named textual, bilingual epigraphic and court-script evidence makes Pallava literary patronage demonstrable, while the court-use limit prevents overgeneralisation.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Assess Pallava contributions to literature and script culture within the wider art-and-...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Discuss manuscripts as documentary heritage and the institutional tasks required for their safeguarding. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** Documentary value depends on disciplined dating, diverse custody, cataloguing, conservation, digitisation and access rather than prestige inscription alone.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition.
- India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture.
- The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians.

**Qualified conclusion:** Documentary value depends on disciplined dating, diverse custody, cataloguing, conservation, digitisation and access rather than prestige inscription alone.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss manuscripts as documentary heritage and the institutional tasks required for their...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Documentary value depends on disciplined dating, diverse custody, cataloguing, conservation, digitisation and access rather than prestige inscription alone.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Composition, redaction, earliest surviving manuscript, critical edition and UNESCO Memory of the World inscription are different dates; the Rigveda's 2007 inscription does not date its composition. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** India's Memory of the World entries include religious, aesthetic, medical, administrative, Persian-chronicle and folk-performance records, so documentary heritage is not synonymous with ancient scripture. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of Culture's Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey, launched 16 March 2026, uses identification, expert verification, metadata creation and conservation or digitisation as four stages without transferring ownership from custodians. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** Documentary value depends on disciplined dating, diverse custody, cataloguing, conservation, digitisation and access rather than prestige inscription alone.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Discuss manuscripts as documentary heritage and the institutional tasks required for their...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Trace how language, script and literature can be used as evidence of social and political change in India. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** Scripts and registers record authority, hierarchy and changing publics, but every inference must remain tied to a dated corpus, inscription or performance convention.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false.
- Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement.
- Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production.
- Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess.
- The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre.
- The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic.

**Qualified conclusion:** Scripts and registers record authority, hierarchy and changing publics, but every inference must remain tied to a dated corpus, inscription or performance convention.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **trace** requires a direct position on "Trace how language, script and literature can be used as evidence of social and political...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** Scripts and registers record authority, hierarchy and changing publics, but every inference must remain tied to a dated corpus, inscription or performance convention.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Ashokan edicts are mostly Prakrit in Brahmi, use Kharoshthi in the northwest, and include Greek and Aramaic at Kandahar; describing them as Sanskrit in Devanagari is false. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Kushana rulers used Greek, Kharoshthi and Brahmi scripts with Greek, Prakrit and Sanskritised registers, demonstrating multilingual coexistence rather than linear replacement. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Buddhist literature spans Pali, Prakrits, Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit and Sanskrit, while Jain literature spans Ardhamagadhi and other Prakrits with later Sanskrit, Apabhramsha and regional-language production. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Bhasa, Kalidasa, Shudraka, Bharavi and Dandin belong to the classical Sanskrit evidence bank, but each work-author pair must be verified; the 2021 and 2024 objective routes are attribution tests, not licence to guess. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Sanskrit-Prakrit speech convention in Gupta-period drama marks social position on stage; it is direct textual evidence for hierarchy but cannot be universalised to every period and genre. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely

listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited routes are 2021 Bhavabhuti-Hastimalla-Kshemeshvara, 2024 Bhasa and provisional 2026 place-value notation objective demands; no direct GS-I Mains PYQ belongs solely to this topic. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

**Counter-position / limit:** A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

**Qualified conclusion:** Scripts and registers record authority, hierarchy and changing publics, but every inference must remain tied to a dated corpus, inscription or performance convention.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

**How to improve this answer:** For “Trace how language, script and literature can be used as evidence of social and political...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.